

# KEYSTONE CANINE TRAINING CLUB

## POLICIES AND PROCEDURES

Revised 6-25-11

### Date Enacted

1. Safety of the dogs and handlers is our first and foremost responsibility.
2. No bitches in season are permitted in classes.
3. The maximum number of students in each class shall be determined by the Instructor, who shall inform the Office Manager of the limit. Handlers in agility classes working multiple dogs must either pay for each dog separately, or only work one dog per sequence.

**revised  
1/15/10**
4. Aggressive dogs shall be dealt with in accordance with the "Policy for Aggressive Dogs," Appendix A.

**8/06**
5. No dogs are to be permitted to use the back of the next building for a "potty" area.
6. All handlers are responsible for cleaning up after their dogs and disposing of it properly, as follows: put papers towels used for urine clean-up in a plastic bag and then put the plastic bag inside the covered trash can, and put all stool in a separate bag and throw away outside in the marked can.
7. No person, member or non-member, is ever permitted to leave a dog in the building unattended.
8. Children should be at least 13 years old to work a dog and all children under 16 must have a parent present, at all times, when working a dog. The only exception to this is if the children are attending a specific class geared to children only.
9. Evaluations for all paying classes shall be handed out in the sixth week and handlers should be requested to return them on the seventh (last) week of class.
10. All instructors' and assistants' dogs shall be contained for any classes that the instructor/assistant is teaching/assisting in. Absolutely NO dog is to be tied, left in a chair, or left in a sit or down stay when the instructor/assistant is working.
11. Use of the KCTC handbook is expressly for KCTC instructors/ assistants only. It is not permissible to copy it or lend it out.

12. Any instructor teaching any class other than Basic Obedience or Novice Obedience is required to submit a syllabus for their seven-week course. The syllabus will be kept on file at KCTC in the event the regular instructor is unable to attend and the sub instructor needs to know where the class is in their course.
13. WEATHER OR SNOW CANCELLATION – Each Instructor should take home a copy of the class roster with the names and phone numbers of the students. In the event of bad weather, each Instructor shall decide whether or not to hold his/her class. If class is cancelled, the Instructor shall either (1) call each student in the class, or (2) notify the call-back person and the website editor as soon as possible, but no later than one hour before the class start time. The call-back person shall change the KCTC phone recording to state that a particular class (or classes) is/are cancelled on a given date, and the website editor shall post a cancellation notice to the website. If the call-back person cannot be contacted, the Instructor shall notify the President. During the first night of class, the Instructor shall either (1) inform the class that the Instructor will call them if class is cancelled, or (2) instruct the class to call the KCTC phone number on bad-weather days to find out if class is cancelled. It is also recommended that the Instructor poll the class the first night to determine how close they live to the club, and if they are willing to drive in bad weather, to help the Instructor decide whether or not to cancel class in the event of bad weather. Another factor in the Instructor's decision should be whether their Assistant(s) are willing to drive to KCTC
14. All instructors will be given a list of names and phone numbers of all instructors and assistants, in the event they need to find a substitute for one of their classes. This list will show what discipline and at what level the person is capable of instructing (e.g., Obedience: Basic, Agility: Advanced, Rally: Intermediate, etc.). It is up to each instructor to find a replacement if needed. If it becomes a problem to find anyone, the Training Director is to be called.
15. Instructors shall not leave a student, assistant, or any other person alone at the building, inside or outside, after a class. Instructors shall wait until everyone is in their car, has it started, and are pulling out of the lot before leaving. This is for the safety of everyone, particularly under harsh winter weather conditions when batteries may die.
16. A list of all people coming to the club needs to be left at the club including the date(s) that person will be at the club, reason for their presence/use of the club as well as contact information. A KCC member must also be present.

**revised  
1/15/10**

**7/08**

17. Any dog working in any class using agility equipment must wear a flat collar or no collar, unless the handler signs a waiver agreeing to hold KCC harmless for any injury to the dog.

18. Apprentice Program

A. Each prospective instructor:

1. For obedience: Must serve an apprenticeship including two seven week basic classes under the guidance of two basic instructors, or one seven-week basic class followed by one seven week novice class.
2. For other disciplines (agility, rally, tracking, etc.), the apprentice must serve an apprenticeship of two seven week classes appropriate for that discipline.
3. Must have a title in the discipline being taught, or have approval of the training director.
4. Must have earned a favorable evaluation from each of the instructors assisted during the apprenticeship period.

B. Apprentice records shall be maintained - original copies to be housed at KCTC.

19. This Policies and Procedures document may be revised by the Training Director as needed, subject to Board approval.

20. A person wishing to propose a recommendation to the Board for approval should send an email to all Board members and should use the words "PROPOSED ITEM FOR BOARD APPROVAL" in the subject of the e-mail. That person should also specifically say in the e-mail what the item or recommendation is and include or attach any supporting documentation. Suggested wording is "I am requesting Board approval for . . ." The club President will include the request on the agenda for the next board meeting where a discussion will take place and a vote taken. **6/7/08**

21. The KCTC Board may conduct business by e-mail, in accordance with Appendix B for emergency votes. **revised 6/7/08**

22. The class drop-in fee will be as stated on the class price list. A liability waiver must be signed by all non-member drop-ins, upon arrival at each class. All drop-in fees collected are to be left at the club and are to be placed in the cash box. Anyone planning to drop-in on any given class must notify the instructor in advance. The instructor will keep the class size to a limit of 8. **Revised 3-22-11**

23. **PRIVATE LESSONS:** Private lessons may be given on a voluntary basis by Instructors or Assistants at the club, not at the client's home or at the Instructor's or Assistant's home. The cost will be \$25 for a ½ hour session, payable to the club. Private lessons will be given when no other classes are in session at the club. **6/7/08**
24. **EMERGENCY PROCEDURES:** Emergency phone numbers have been posted on the side of the refrigerator. A similar list has been posted on the cabinet with the first aid kit (marked with a red cross), and includes emergency contacts numbers for Board members who live close to the club. An Incident Report should be filled out for any emergency. **8/20/08**
25. **CLUB MAILING LIST:** Article XI Section 3 of the Bylaws requires Board approval of the use of the club mailing list. This is clarified as follows: Board approval is not required to use the club mailing list for normal club business (such as sending the newsletter) and sending club announcements (such as fundraisers). The club's mailing list (including both the street address list and the e-mail list) is considered club property. Personal messages to the membership, using either list, shall be approved by the Board. Any messages to the club membership shall be distributed by the Corresponding Secretary or his/her designated back-up. **12/15/08**
26. **CLUB PURCHASES –** Board of Directors approval is required for any purchases over \$50, and membership approval (by simple majority vote) is required for any purchases over \$1000. Such purchases will be announced at the next general membership meeting or via the club newsletter. Exceptions include: rent, utilities, insurance, promotional advertising, postage, sales tax, concession purchases, newsletter expenses, enrollment refunds, re-saleable pet supplies, office supplies, (envelopes, computer ribbons, photo copying, diploma paper, etc.), building maintenance (bulbs, filters, cleaning supplies, paint, paper supplies, pest control, etc.), match and trial supplies (cash for change, flyers, raffle tickets, armbands, prize ribbons/rosettes, food, site rental fee, score sheets, judge's gifts, etc.), holiday party expenses (site rental fee, plaques), community day fee, and reimbursements to members for any of the above. **9/24/10**
27. **LAPSED MEMBERSHIP –** A person or family whose membership has lapsed but wants to rejoin the club may do so by submitting a new membership application and paying the membership dues. They must also take classes at the non-member rate and be voted upon by the membership in accordance with the following: **1/15/10**

| <i>Time since membership has lapsed</i> | <i>Number of paying classes that must be taken at the non-member rate</i> | <i>Membership vote on the application</i> |
|-----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| 0 – 1 year                              | None                                                                      | Not required                              |
| 1 – 2 years                             | One                                                                       | Required                                  |
| Greater than 2 years                    | Two                                                                       | Required                                  |

28. CLASS FEES FOR NEW APPLICANTS – If approved by the Board of Directors, an applicant who has taken two classes at the non-member rate and then submitted a membership application, may take a third class at the member rate if the class start date is prior to the date of the membership vote on the applicant. **1/15/10**
29. SIGN-IN SHEET – Any person using the building during non-class hours shall sign in and out with their name, time in, and time out. The sign-in sheet will be on or near the main entrance door. This does not apply to scheduled events. **1/15/10**
30. CLASS ENROLLMENT PROCEDURE - Class enrollment will be in chronological order, in accordance with the following: After the "Class Schedule" is officially posted on the website or sent out in the newsletter, people can fill out an enrollment form and send it in. People can either mail it to our PO Box or place it in an envelope and put it in the cash box on the wall in the office along with payment. (Note - people may not enroll for a class before the class schedule is posted on the website or sent out in the newsletter.) People can pay for more than one class with a single check (or cash). People will then be enrolled in the order in which the enrollment forms are received. If people enroll after the class limit is reached, they will be informed that the class is full. **4/23/10**
31. K-9ERS – The K-9ers reserve the right to approve any new participants in their group. This includes practices as well as events. Only dogs who are CGC certified may participate in K-9er or KCTC events and demos. In addition, dogs shall be TDI certified to do any visitation with individuals when that visitation is part of a K-9er or KCTC demo or visit. **4/23/10**
32. BUILDING RENTAL – The building may be rented to outside organizations for a fee of \$25 per hour. A KCTC member must be present during the event. The member sponsoring the event is responsible for moving any equipment and cleaning up before and after the event. (Note – regularly scheduled cleaning will not be rescheduled for such events.) **3/23/11**

## **APPENDIX A: POLICY FOR AGGRESSIVE DOGS**

1. All students are currently required to sign a liability waiver, accepting responsibility for their dog's behavior and absolving the Keystone Canine Training Club of responsibility for any injuries to people or other dogs.
2. All members will be required to sign a similar waiver. This will become effective for all new members, and for members who renewed during the most recent renewal period (starting June 2006).
3. No aggressive dogs are allowed to participate in any Keystone sponsored or affiliated demonstrations or public events.
4. In class, if a dog shows aggressiveness toward people, the Instructor shall take the following actions:
  - Advise the student to keep the dog away from other people,
  - Alert the other students to stay away from that dog,
  - Advise the student that he or she must keep the dog under control at all times,
  - Advise the student to seek additional individual outside help, and
  - At the Instructor's discretion, advise the student to withdraw from the class and refund the class fee.
5. The Instructor shall also record the incident on an Incident Report form.
6. In class, if a dog shows aggressiveness toward another dog, the Instructor shall take the same actions as for dog-to-people aggressiveness above. Examples of dog-to-dog aggressiveness may include behavior such as lunging, barking, snapping, biting, growling, and baring of teeth.
7. If a member's dog has an incident with another member's dog, the member shall proceed as follows:
  - First incident: Advise the Instructor.
  - Second incident: Advise the Training Director, who shall talk to the member involved, evaluate the dog if appropriate, and document the findings.
  - If a member wishes to lodge a formal complaint about another member's dog, the member shall document the incident in a formal Incident Report and submit it to the Instructor or Training Director. The incident will be handled in accordance with the disciplinary section

of the Bylaws.

## **APPENDIX B: KCTC BOARD POLICY ON E-MAIL VOTING**

### **GUIDANCE FOR EMAIL VOTING**

**6/7/08 REVISED**

Any member of the KCTC Board of Directors may submit a request for approval by the Board via email vote on items of an urgent nature. The use of e-mail voting will be for **emergencies only**.

All other non-emergency items should be held for the next Board meeting.

### **FORMAT FOR E-MAIL VOTING**

The person making the recommendation should use the words "EMERGENCY REQUEST FOR BOARD APPROVAL" in the Subject of the e-mail. That person should also specifically say in the e-mail what the item or recommendation is and include or attach any supporting documentation. Suggested wording is "I am requesting an emergency e-mail vote for Board approval for . . ."

### **RESPONSES FOR E-MAIL VOTING**

All Board members shall "Reply All" to the request for an approval vote within five days of the date of the e-mail request. The response should say "Yes" or "No" (not "Sounds good to me" or words to that effect). If a Board member considers that the request warrants a discussion at the next Board meeting rather than an immediate decision, the response should say "No, defer until the next Board meeting" and the reason why. The voting process shall be exactly the same as for regular Board meetings, in accordance with the club Bylaws: (1) a quorum for a valid vote is a majority of the Board members (a quorum is 6 as of this writing, based upon 11 Board members), and (2) votes are determined by a simple majority of those voting.

### **DOCUMENTATION FOR E-MAIL VOTING**

The person making the request shall keep track of the responses, and shall advise the Recording Secretary of the vote. The Recording Secretary shall document the vote in the next Board meeting minutes.

## **APPENDIX C: INSTRUCTOR PERKS**

**Revised 6/25/11**

**QUALIFICATION:** Teach and/or assist in three sessions or 21 classes. Qualified instructors and assistants are then entitled to:

- Free classes
- Half off dues
- Discounted rates on seminars
- Recognition at our Holiday Dinner

**INSTRUCTOR AND ASSISTANT PERKS** - Qualified Instructors and Assistants are entitled to one free class of any type (including Specialty Classes), with one dog, for each class that they teach during the current session.

Instructors may use the building when classes or events are not scheduled, in accordance with the following: First, check the Building Usage schedule on the website to pick a time when the building is free. Then send an e-mail to [info@keystonecanine.com](mailto:info@keystonecanine.com) with your name and desired time slot (date and time). The time is limited to two hours per week, ending no later than one hour before any scheduled class or event. A contact person will confirm your time slot and add your name to the schedule on the website. Please note that any official club events (seminars, run-thrus, etc.) supersede private building usage, even if they are scheduled after you reserve a time slot. Building usage is for the private use of instructors, not for formal lessons or classes, and non-members are not allowed to participate. Other requirements on the Building Usage website also apply (such as signing in and out).

## **APPENDIX D: AGILITY EQUIPMENT POLICY**

**Revised March 22, 2011**

For non-agility classes, including basic obedience classes, only the following equipment is allowed to be used:

- Open tunnels
- Weave poles with short (blue-striped) poles only
- Bar jumps with cups set at a low height relative to the dog's size
- Pause table

The full-size agility equipment will be normally be left set up in the front room all week except for when a special event is held (such as a Teacup trial, seminar, outside event rental, etc.), or for other extenuating circumstances when approved by the Training Director.

When the agility equipment is taken down, the heavy equipment should be left against the walls in the front room. When special events are held in the front room, the agility equipment should be temporarily moved to the back room in an out-of-the-way location such as along the walls.

## **APPENDIX E: INSTRUCTOR EXPECTATIONS, APPOINTMENTS, AND PERFORMANCE EVALUATIONS**

**December 15, 2008**

**INSTRUCTOR EXPECTATIONS:** Instructors and assistants are encouraged to do the following things to enhance the quality of their classes:

- Follow the syllabus (for classes with a syllabus)
- Be in charge at all times
- Keep the class moving
- Keep the handlers interested
- Give them something to strive for
- Demonstrate each command being taught
- Show interest and care for each handler
- Learn the dogs' and handlers' names as quickly as possible
- Be creative – add your humor and personality to your class
- Give equal attention to the entire class (yes, this can be hard at times!)
- Evaluate the dogs in the first two weeks, looking for aggressive or problem dogs
- Think safety – be alert to tripping hazards and ask handlers to give other dogs their needed space
- Hand out evaluation forms at the end of the session, and give the filled-out forms to the Training Director (for Basic Obedience, do this half-way through the session also)
- Conform to the agility equipment policy of APPENDIX D
- Most importantly – HAVE FUN!

**THINGS INSTRUCTORS AND ASSISTANTS SHOULD NOT DO:**

- Be negative
- Sit for a lengthy time while instructing
- Let students stand around talking or stand around on one item for a long time (assistants can work one-on-one while you keep it moving)
- Talk about yourself or your dog too much (they are here to learn, not to hear you brag)
- Avoid tough dogs or difficult handlers
- Leave your dog not confined or crated when not actively performing demonstrations

### **INSTRUCTOR APPOINTMENTS**

Instructors and assistants shall be appointed or approved by the Training Director, and shall serve at the will of the Training Director. The Training Director may dismiss any instructor or assistant at any time for cause, subject to the approval of the Board.

### **INSTRUCTOR EVALUATIONS**

1. The Training Director (TD) will observe each class and each instructor and assistant at least once a year, and should review the class evaluation forms filled out by the students. The TD may appoint one or more experienced instructors to assist in this effort.

2. Based on those observations and on the class evaluation forms filled out by the students, the TD shall provide any appropriate feedback and suggestions to the instructors and assistants. The TD should also share any “best practices” he or she observes with other instructors and assistants.
3. In the event that the TD considers the instructor’s performance is unsatisfactory, the TD shall provide the instructor with a written performance evaluation, citing the positives and the negatives, and list the specific things that require improvement.
4. After receipt of the written report, the instructor must agree to correct the deficiencies and be re-evaluated by the TD at a mutually agreed-upon upcoming class.
5. If the deficiencies are not corrected, the TD shall inform the instructor that he or she may not teach any classes after the current session.